Fairytale Fiasco

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F/F, F/M

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by AstrynSerene

Summary

Glimmer accidently gets the Best Friend Squad trapped in a book of fairytales, and the only way to escape is to go through the books. It would be easier if they were all in the same story!

Chapter 1

Catra yawned as she flopped onto the couch next to Adora, resting her head in her lover's lap, "Remind me again why this couldn't wait until tomorrow, Sparkles?"

"Absolutely not! I know you two grew up with.. twisted children's bedtime stories, but I absolutely refuse to let this monstrosity go on any further!" The queen exclaimed, teleporting across the library and back, landing on the couch now holding a book entitled Enchanted in her hands.

"So you dragged us out of bed to read us a bedtime story meant for babies?" Catra scoffed, rolling her eyes.

"Yes I did."

"It's important to have good, simple stories like this in your life! Besides, we were having a Best Friend Squad Sleepover anyyyyway, so why not?" Bow gave the couple a pleading look and warm smile, a look even Catra had trouble rejecting.

One more look from Adora finally got Catra to relent, "Ughhh, fine. Let me see the stupid book."

Smug she had won, Glimmer passed the book to the magicat, who glanced over the cover, squinting. She sniffed the book

before squinting, sneezing and holding the book at arm's length from her face, "Why does everything here smell like magic?"

"It's a book, Catra. It's probably just my teleportation remnants." The queen took the book back so Catra wouldn't fall into another magical sneezing fit.

"Uhh, no. Your magic scent is different from.. whatever that is."

"I still can't believe all magic had different scents." Adora mused.

"Well, you're not a magicat." Catra hummed, booping Adora's forehead, "My sense of smell is like- a hundred times better than all of yours."

While the couple teased each other, the queen had flipped open the book, only to find something different than a normal title page, "Huh, that's weird."

Glimmer's confusion took back everyone's attention, "What is it?" Bow asked, scooting closer to his girlfriend to see what she was looking at.

"There's some First One's language written down here. What's it say, Adora?" Glimmer handed the book to her friend, who squinted at the words.

"Enter these stories and take a spin, don't take this challenge on a whim. Work together to get to the end, and remember that time will be your friend." The text had begun to glow as the blonde read.

"Uhh, Sparkles. Why is the book glowing?"

"Beats me-" Glimmer cut herself off as her eyes widened. She suddenly realized why the book was titled the way it was, "Oooh crap."

The glowing soon became a beacon light that engulfed the room and blinded the Best Friend Squad.

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Bow groaned as he slowly blinked, trying to recover from the blinding light of the book. Once his eyes readjusted, it took him mere seconds to realize he was no longer on the couch, or even in Brightmoon for that matter. If he had to guess, he had to be in the Whispering Woods.

Getting to his feet, he took in his surroundings. He was on a dirt pathway, and no longer in his pajamas. Instead, he was wearing a red crop top with yellow rounded sleeves and a navy blue skirt with black leggings underneath. Topping off the look was yellow

lace up boots, a short red cape attached at the shoulders, and a headband with a matching blue bow on it. He smiled momentarily before his eyes landed on the apple decals on his shoes and the color scheme of his outfit that made something click.

He was dressed as Snow White. That combined with Catra complaining about smelling magic on the book and a sudden change of scenery told him one thing: they were

now trapped in a magical book of fairytales. Worse than that, he was completely alone and had no idea how to get back to the others.

"Okay.. deep breaths, Bow. Just relax." He took a few deep breaths as he began to walk down the pathway. He knew his best bet was to just follow the story he'd been dropped into, in hopes of finding his friends, or at least a clue as to how to get back home.

So, despite all fight or flight instincts he was feeling, he began to make his way down the dirt pathway in hopes of finding something, or someone, familiar.

Bow White the Tech Master

Chapter Summary

> Bow finds himself inside the story of Snow White. With a very tech advanced Evil Queen, he's able to learn a lot about the world he's trapped in.

When Bow first stumbled upon the castle in the Whispering Woods, his first question was how the Crypto Castle wound up outside of Dryl.

"Fairytale world, Bow. It's not.. Etheria, the same Etheria anyway." Part of him wondered if they'd been teleported inside the book or to a new dimension entirely. Wait, isn't that the same thing? Technically? Ugh! Groaning, he decided that once they got out of this mess he would talk to Entrapta about it. The real one anyway. He was pretty certain the one inside the palace before him wouldn't be self aware of the situation. Probably.

Taking a deep breath, he slowly made his way up the stairs and approached the door. Maybe in this world the castle wouldn't be a maze? One knock on the door resulting in the floor falling from underneath him was the quick answer he did not want. He screamed as he fell down a tube and was dropped into a small dome of a cage. He groaned, pushing his cape off his face and back behind him as he sat up, "This is not the Snow White story I remember…" he huffed. It was clear these versions of the stories had been modified. He knew if he just played through the story he'd surely complete the challenge and find the others, but it would be harder when he wasn't sure how much of it had been altered.

"Gotta admit, I'm surprised it was you that got trapped in here!"

Screaming at the sudden voice, he looked up and calmed himself when it was only Entrapta.

"Being *such* a master at tech and all, I'd think you'd be able to spot the traps in your own house." She mused, pushing a lever that opened the door, allowing him to crawl out and finally get to his feet.

"Uhhh, I forgot about that.. one?" He tried, now thoroughly confused.

Clearly not convinced, the princess just rolled her eyes. She was still Entrapta, just a little.. meaner? Bow was piecing together the role she had been put in, and was now very nervous about finding any apples or- anything edible she might offer him.

"Well, are you just gonna stand there?" Entrapta asked, having already turned to leave the room.

"Right! Uh, sorry!" He squeaked, scrambling to catch up with her.

"Why are you even here? I only sent you out to collect that data an hour ago."

If his memory served him correctly, in the original the Evil Queen had sent Snow White to pick flowers, or something along those lines, as a distraction for the huntsman to kill her. Was this supposed to be after that? He couldn't worry too much about that now, he supposed. He had to focus on getting through this without getting poisoned. What if he had to be woken up by a kiss from someone who wasn't Glimmer?! He couldn't cheat on her! It would crush them both!

"Riiight, uhm, I got.. sidetracked?"

"By what?"

As they entered what Bow assumed was a throne room (definitely a new Crypto Castle, as the original didn't have one), he was interrupted by the door flying open. He was relieved for about two seconds that he didn't have to find an excuse, only to tense at seeing Wrong Hordak of all people, dressed as what Bow could only guess was a huntsman. The thought of one of the arrows in the quiver on his back piercing his chest sent shivers down his spine, "I apologize princess, but I seem to have lost the-" catching sight of Bow, Wrong Hordak cleared his throat, "Oh! Uhm, I see you have located him."

"Yes, and we have some work to do, could you please bring some tiny snacks? I'm starving!"

"Oh! Of course! I apologize for being gone longer than expected!" He proclaimed before hurrying out of the room.

"He cooks and hunts for you..?" Bow asked, unable to help himself.

"Yeesh, did you hit your head? You know he makes all my snacks! He's the best at making sure everything is the perfect portion!"

"Oh! Yeah, yeah, of course. Just… tired, I guess?" He followed Entrapta to a set of couches facing each other, a coffee table separating them. He took the seat opposite to her when prompted. He sat in a tense silence for a few moments before sighing. He knew it was an absolute long shot, but he had to figure out how this world worked and how self aware the others were. He opened his mouth to speak, but Entrapta beat him to it.

"Hordak says you're still seen as the greatest tech master in the kingdom you know." She said pensively.

"Hor..dak?"

The princess simply pointed to a mirror on the wall, and Bow had to literally bite his tongue. The leader of the Horde, a multi decade battle, reduced to a mirror. The grumpy look on his face only made it harder for Bow not to burst out laughing.

Taking a few deep breaths and swallowing his laughter, he brought his focus back to the new information. So he wasn't the

fairest, but the.. smartest? Techy-est? He definitely wasn't smarter than her, but fairytale rules had to place them in a somewhat related situation for them he guessed. He would just have to go with it if he had any hope of finding the others and getting home, "Right, right yes. Uh, yeah, I.. I don't know how that's possible when I learned everything from you for the most part. You've always been my biggest inspiration."

"That's certainly news to me." The princess paused, seeming more than surprised to learn this, "It's.. nice to know you appreciate me."

"Of course I do. You've taught me so much over the years. My arrow arsenal wouldn't be even half as advanced as it is without your advice and ideas! Anyone who thinks I got where I am on my own doesn't know anything about me."

"Nourishment has arrived!" Wrong Hordak suddenly exclaimed, walking into the room, silver tray in hand, "I brought the *special* tiny tarts you requested" he said to Entrapta with an over exaggerated wink. Entrapta only stared blankly, as if confused as he left the room.

Enjoying a now more relaxed atmosphere with who felt more like the Entrapta he knew, Bow took one of the treats, taking a bite after she did, "I'm sorry for seeming so grumpy, especially when you've been so uncharacteristically nice to me today compared to the memories I contain of our past interactions." Entrapta rambled, eating one of the blue tarts, not taking notice of Bow eating the only red one.

"Past interactions? Was I acting differently yesterday?" He questioned.

"Up until today you've always been standoffish with me and focused on letting everyone see the tech you use and things you invent to help the kingdom and any time I mentioned it you always brushed it off and were a little rude about it. It's hard to explain, but you seem like a completely different person. Everyone always assumes you run things and I'm under you. It's… upsetting."

Bow frowned, furrowing his eyebrows, "That isn't right, and wouldn't be true in any universe, Entrapta. Speaking of, if I were to tell you I'm from another dimension and got pulled into a storybook world and was now lost and needing to find my friends and girlfriend, what would you say?"

Entrapta stared blankly for a moment before a bright smile took over her expression, "..I'd think you were crazy! But also, fascinating! The idea of inter dimensional travel is so exciting! I'd have so many questions!"

"Well… let's pretend that is the case.. What would I do?" He took another bite of the tart as she replied.

"I'd ask how you got here to begin with, first off."

"An apparent spell written in a language only my friend can read."

"Do you remember what it said?"

"It warned us not to just take the challenge on a whim, that we had to work together, and time would be our friend?" I can't remember the exact words, but that was basically it." Grabbing a nearby notepad, the princess began jotting it all down, "By the way, the tart was really good." He added, having finished it.

"I'm glad! I believe you ate the apple one, since only blueberry ones are on the tray now!"

Freezing, and eyes widening, Bow suddenly connected the dots as to why Wrong Hordak was acting weird. His vision blurred before he could get another word out as he fell unconscious seconds later.

Entrapta stared in shock for a solid minute, "..Oooh, right! I forgot we added the sleep solution to that one. Hordak! I need the antidote!" She squeaked, rushing over to the mirror, "I have reason to believe he is not the original Bow from our universe and now I feel terrible for hurting him when really I shouldn't have at all and I also really wanna learn about his universe!"

"The antidote is on the page after the one you got the poison from, Entrapta."

"Riggght!" The princess skidded over to a table covered in ingredients, a tiny cauldron, a book, and a few bits of tech scattered across it. She skimmed the book until she found was she was looking for, before quickly beginning to mix the potion.

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Bow groaned as he slowly came too. His head hurt, and he felt dizzy. He slowly opened his eyes, finding he was now laying on the couch, "What.. happened?"

"Good morning! Or- it's noon, so afternoon! How are you feeling?" Entrapta asked, suddenly at his side and looking down at him with both concern and intrigue.

"I'm fine… Di-..Did you poison me..?" He asked warily upon remembering why he fainted.

"I'm sorry! It was an accident! And it wasn't technically poison-poison. Just- something to put you to sleep for a while because I was upset. I know it was wrong, especially after you've been so nice today. I do have a way to make it up to you though!"

"Oh..? Well, I accept your apology anyway." He smiled slightly, sitting up as his friend retreated to the other couch. He knew she was only doing what the story pushed her to do.

"After I gave you the antidote, I looked back over this spell you were telling me about. From what I deciphered, you're on a timer to find your friends, complete whatever challenges your story gives you, and on a time limit to finish or you'll be trapped here."

His eyes widened, "Wait you figured out-"

"-that you got transported to our dimension from another that's extremely similar without the fairy tale aspects? Yes, and while I can't tell you exactly what to do because we don't know where the other three are or what stories they're in-"

"Wait. If I replaced a different version of me, that means the others did too. If I give you names maybe you could tell me where they are?"

"Yes!" Now she was excited again.

"Okay, so my girlfriend is Glimmer, and my friends are Catra and Adora."

"I know two of them! Glimmer and Adora are sisters, daughters to Queen Angella and King Micah of Brightmoon, the kingdom past ours here in the forest. But Princess Adora was kidnapped as a baby and we don't know where she is. To protect Glimmer from the same fate she was sent away to be raised by fairies here in the woods."

"So she's… sleeping beauty!" Bow smiled, "Why was Adora taken..?"

"Her hair possesses magical healing properties after a magic flower was used to heal the Queen during her pregnancy."

"Rapunzel! Perfect, two of them are out here somewhere then. That just leaves Catra, but I'm sure we'll find her along the way. Thank you so much!"

"Of course! I'll stay here while you go search, maybe Hordak and I can find out where Catra is?"

"That would be really helpful. I'll come back once I find one or both of the other two. If I'm not back by sundown, something happened and we might need help."

Entrapta nodded. Before he could leave though, she grabbed his wrist, "By the way, the part about time. It clearly means you all have a time limit. I don't know what exactly it is, but you need to keep it in mind."

"I will, I'll see you soon." He promised, the two sharing a quick hug before Bow raced out of the castle and back into the Whispering Woods.

Magicat in Cinders & a Drop of Sunlight

Chapter Summary

> Catra learns this world holds people she never wanted to see again, and hears words she never thought she'd hear. While Adora finds herself with She-Ra's platinum blonde hair, but much, much longer than before. Their reunion is one much needed.

Chapter Notes

> I know you have all been looking forward to finding out where Catra was placed, and I hope I don't disappoint!!

Morning moon rays hit Catra right in the eyes as she slowly woke up. She groaned, sitting up and looking around, "The hell..?" She was in a small room on a falling apart cot, surrounded by broken furniture, boarded windows, and a wardrobe with rags for clothes. She slowly stood, realizing she was in a patchwork red dress with a partially torn off-white apron over it. Her hair had grown back out somehow, no longer a pixie cut, but long and voluminous, tied back into a low ponytail by a red ribbon.

Where was she? If she didn't know better (and really, she didn't), she would say she was either locked in a prison cell or someone's maid. She didn't want either to be true. Groaning, she started looking around for a way out, "This is so stupid," she muttered, "If this is how Rebellion stories are, they had little room to talk about ours." She huffed, finally spotting a door. She approached, slowly, and grabbed the door knob. She was relieved when the door opened, but she still didn't feel any better to be faced with a spiral staircase going down at least two stories. She must be in a tower. She took a deep breath and slowly descended the staircase, keeping light on her toes, just in case. She wished Adora- or even Bow or Glimmer- was here. Any of them would have more

knowledge on what to do in this situation than she did, leaving her feeling far more vulnerable and trapped than she liked.

When she reached the bottom of the stairs she quietly pushed open the door, revealing the hallway of a- castle? manor? She wasn't entirely sure. Gulping down her unease, she made her way down the hall, her ears twitching as she listened for voices, or any sound that indicated someone she could ask for help. She heard familiar voices moments later. Mermista and Perfuma she believed. At least she was on good terms with one of them.

She reached the door and pushed it open. Perfuma was standing at the window sill, growing flowers in a few pots, and Mermista was reading on a couch. They both looked up when Catra entered the room, "Thank goodness, familiar faces." Catra sighed, smiling slightly as she approached Perfuma, "Have you guys seen Adora or Glimmer? Or Bow? We got separated after some weird magic spell Sparkles cast and I have no idea what's going on or where I am."

The women stared at her for a moment before both busted out laughing at her. Her ears pinned against her head, her smile fading.

"W-What..?"

"As if you would know the prince or either of the royal sisters!" Mermista scoffed, "Especially considering one of them has been missing for eighteen years and the other hasn't been seen publicly for sixteen."

"And the prince is too busy to make time for anything outside of his work, especially a servant like you."

Hearing Mermista talk lowly of her wasn't completely new, but Perfuma was her friend and really- her therapist. So hearing her being so nasty was a hard blow to the gut. They clearly weren't the real people she knew, but it still hurt all the same,"I… no, I-"

"Girls, what's going on here?"

Catra froze up instantly, eyes widening. She knew that haunting, cold voice. But it couldn't be. She was.. She was dead! She saw her die! She slowly turned around, her breath hitching as she was faced with none other than Shadow Weaver herself, "S-Sh-.." Her hands began trembling. She looked different, now without a mask and scars, she looked like what Castaspella described her appearance to be when she was Light Spinner.

"I think the bleach has finally gone to Catra's head, mother." Mermista chuckled, "She barged in here asking about the princesses and the prince like she knows them personally!"

"Is that so?" The woman towered over Catra, "Well, it's disrespectful enough that you barged in on my daughters, but to ramble like a delirious old woman is another."

"S-S…" Catra was still trembling, her voice caught in her throat.

"Speak up, child! I raised you better than that!" Shadow Weaver snapped.

".. Shadow Weaver?" Catra whispered, still not believing what was right in front of her. She gasped when she was suddenly struck across the face hard enough to send her to the floor.

"How dare you call me by name! I'm your step mother and you will address me as such! I don't know what has gotten into you but if you think this is the way to get my permission to attend the royal ball this evening you are sorely mistaken!"

Royal ball? What was she talking about? Part of her wanted to ask, but she knew she would only get laughed at and/or yelled at some more. So, as much as she loathed the idea of calling that monster anything but what she was, she realized she had no other active choices to make right now. All she could do was play along, "... I.. I'm sorry, step mother…" she finally settled on, irritated at how meek she sounded.

"As you should be. Now get off the ground. It's very un ladylike." Catra slowly rose, fighting to ignore the snickering behind her, "Now, as you know, tonight is the royal ball to celebrate the return of Princess Glimmer, and my daughters require new gowns for the occasion. You are to go to the village and fetch them from the tailors. I've also left you a list of groceries. You have an hour to be back with all of it. Understand?"

"Yes, step mother.." Catra replied. Surely she could find Adora in that time!

"Well, what are you waiting for? Go!"

Nodding, Catra left the room, her ears still tightly pinned to her head as sounds of mock laughter was left trailing behind her.

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As Catra made her way down the dirt path towards the village, she couldn't help but notice an odd patch of ivy against a wall of rocks and trees she knew usually led to the outpost where they built their camp at the tail end of the war. Curiosity getting the better of her, she approached the wall, pushing the vines and ivy aside, and was greeted by a cave entrance.

"Huh…"

As she made her way through, she was soon led to a beautiful clearing of different landscape, bushes, flowers, and a lovely flowing waterfall that dropped into a clear pond. However, instead of the hidden campsite, a tall tower stood in its place.

"Whoa…" the tower only seemed to get bigger the closer she got to it. Maybe Adora- or any of the others- would be there. It certainly seemed like someone was being held inside anyway. So, taking a deep breath, she unsheathed her claws, and began to scale the side of the tower.

It took a while, probably close to ten minutes. She wasn't used to being restricted by stupid dresses, but at least the tower wasn't smooth like the walls of Brightmoon. Once she reached the top, she groaned as she toppled through the window sill, barely managing to stay on her feet. She looked around, gasping and backing up when she saw a frying pan almost in her face, the wielder in the shadows, "I.. Uh, I'm not a threat I-"

The frying pan suddenly fell to the ground, a female gasping, "Catra!" Came no other than Adora's voice as she rushed forward and enveloped her partner in a hug, which the latter returned desperately, the two sinking to the floor as their lips crashed together, "Oh I missed you so much, I didn't know what happened or where I was..!" She peppered little kisses across Catra's face.

Catra looked up, tears running down her face as emotions overwhelmed her, quickly gaining the blonde's attention, "Catra? What's the matter..?"

"S-Shadow Weaver… she's here.. She's- alive here..!" Adora's eyes widened, "I don't know what monster of a story I'm supposed to be in, but I'm being forced to call her step mother and I'm her maid and Mermista and Perfuma are her daughters!"

Adora cringed, "That's.. That's a lot. I'm so sorry, I've gotchu now."

"I-I know, just-" Catra trailed off, finally getting a good look at Adora for the first time as she wiped her eyes, "..What happened to your hair?" Her eyes widened slightly when she realized just how long it was. It seemed to go on for miles around the tower.

"I.. I don't know," Adora admitted sheepishly, "I woke up here with seventy feet of platinum blonde hair and trapped inside this tower by myself. I was about to try and climb down when you showed up.

"Well.. I don't know exactly why you're here, but when I mentioned you, Sparkles, and Bow, Mermista said all of you were princesses and a prince, and that one of the princesses had gone missing. And Shadow Weaver said there was a royal ball tonight in honor of Glimmer returning, so I'm guessing the one that went missing is you."

"Oh- okay, wow. So Glimmer and I are- sisters.. here. That's a new one. Well, I guess that means I've been kidnapped. Again."

"At least it's not by me this time?" Catra offered, pleased the joke got a laugh out of Adora.

"Well, maybe we should get out of here then and find-"

"Adora~!" A voice called from below. Now Adora was the one tensing, "Let down your hair!"

"Who is that..?" Catra whispered.

"L-Light Hope," Adora replied, clearing her throat, "She's the one who pulled me through the portal and manipulated me to balance the planet and activate the Heart."

"What do we do?"

"I.." Adora looked around, spotting a wardrobe against the wall, "Hide in here!" She took Catra's hand and led her over, giving her a quick kiss before pushing her inside and shutting the door. Catra bit her lip, doing her best to stay quiet.

"Adora! I'm not getting any younger down here!"

"Uh- coming!" Adora quickly made her way to the window. She noticed a hook above her and looped her hair around it before tossing the rest of her tresses down the side of the tower. Once Light Hope was ready, the blonde lifted the older woman with ease to the window sill.

"Goodness Adora, I'm not sure how you manage that every day without failure." Light Hope gushed, taking off her cape and hooking it on the rack.

"Oh uh- it was nothing?"

"Of course, you've always been quite strong haven't you?" Light Hope guided Adora over to a mirror by her shoulders.

"I guess.. Actually, could I ask you-"

Catra was watching through the small crack in the doorway, her eyes narrowed with suspicion as her partner was interrupted.

"Hm, you know what I see here?"

"What..?"

"A strong, beautiful young lady."

"Oh, uh, thank-"

"-Oh look, you're here too!" Adora frowned before Light Hope chuckled, "Oh, I'm only teasing you."

Catra growled under her breath.

"Uhm, oh-" Adora bit her lip. She remembered what Catra had mentioned, about a royal ball, and debated asking about it. It was probably a questionable choice, but she was curious, "Actually… uh, m-mother? I- wanted to ask you a question-"

"Adora, mother's feeling a bit down, could you sing for me? Then we'll talk."

"S-Sing..?" Before she could ask further, a soft melody filled her mind, a short set of lyrics following, "Uhm, of- course..." She blushed, knowing Catra was witnessing all of this, but had little choice otherwise. She hadn't sung in… a while. There had been the occasional time for fun at parties, but she never thought she was any good.

Swallowing the lump in her throat, she made her way over to the fireplace, lowering herself onto a stool in front of a chair, watching as Light Hope approached, taking a seat after grabbing a hairbrush. Though she was utterly confused, once she felt the brush began to run gently through her hair, she closed her eyes, and began singing, "*Flower, gleam, and glow*…"

As she sang, her hair started to glow, running from her scalp to the ends hanging over the stairwell. Catra had to bite back her gasp as she watched and listened, her ears perking up. Sure, the healing ability she was displaying was impressive, but Catra knew she could do that. What she didn't know was how beautiful her girlfriend's voice was. She hadn't heard her sing since she hummed her lullabies as little kids in the Horde. She felt as if she was falling in love all over again, a soft smile forming on her face. She knew by the heat in her cheeks that her face was growing a deeper shade of red by the second. Her tail swayed ever so slightly to the tune.

"...*Bring back what once was mine; what once was mine*..."

"Thank you, dear. Now, what was it you wanted to talk about?" Light Hope set down the brush as Adora turned to face her. The blonde noted how much younger she now looked. Any wrinkles or gray hair was gone. Huh.

"Right, uhm. I was just wondering if maybe…" she looked around. It was risky to ask to attend a party she shouldn't know about. She debated deflecting until she noticed a painting on the wall. It had her sitting in a field watching a sky filled with lights of some kind. Stars? Lanterns maybe? She couldn't quite tell for sure, "I was wondering if maybe you could let me- no, take me to see the- the floating lights?"

Catra furrowed her eyebrows at that. She gently facepalmed.

"Oh, please, not the lights again. Adora, you know why you can't leave this tower. If others knew of your special gift they would do anything to abuse it."

Adora felt a tiny sense of relief. At least she had found something that wasn't completely out of pocket, "Well, you would be there right? Besides, I'm old enough now!"

"Just because you turn eighteen today doesn't mean you're able to handle yourself out there. Even with me. You've been here your entire life. I'm sorry but it's just much too dangerous."

Adora pouted her lower lip slightly, frustrated. If this conversation didn't scream kidnapped she didn't know what did. At least she was getting some information, "I think I would be capable of handling myself actually. It's not like we'd have to go somewhere super public-"

"-Adora. We are done talking about this." Light Hope narrowed her eyes. Her tone was a warning.

"Okay, but I just-"

"-Adora-"

"-Would you please-"

"-ENOUGH with the lights, Adora! You are not leaving this tower! Ever!"

Adora's breath hitched as she froze. She didn't know why being yelled at like that affected her so much so suddenly. Maybe it was the fact she knew she was currently in a hostage situation, or the words spoken, or who they were spoken by, but she felt a few tears run down her face.

"Ugh, great. Now I'm the bad guy." Light Hope scoffed.

Biting her lip, Adora stole a glance at the wardrobe, before wiping her eyes and straightening her posture. Maybe she couldn't convince Light Hope to let her out, but maybe she could get her to leave her alone long enough to leave on her own. Light Hope said she turned eighteen that day, so that meant it was her character's birthday!

"...all I was gonna say, was that.. I.. I know what I want for my birthday..?"

"And what is that?"

"Uhm.." She glanced around. Paintings covered the walls. She was no artist, but that didn't mean whoever she was playing wasn't, "New paints? The.. acrylics you once brought?"

"That's quite the trip, Adora. Almost three days."

"Well… like you said, I know I'm safe as long as I'm here."

Sighing, the older woman approached, "You sure you'll be okay all alone? I'd hate to leave you on your birthday."

"I'll be okay." Adora offered a small smile.

Nodding, the two embraced before packing a basket together, and Adora was soon lowering Light Hope to the base of the tower. She waved, watching her depart before rushing over to the wardrobe and opening it, catching Catra as she stumbled out, "Well, that was.. something." The magicat said, "Are you okay?"

"Yeah! Yeah.. I'm fine," Adora chuckled, "Just, wow. I never thought I'd see her again. I'm just glad I found something to get her to leave."

"How's it feel to be eighteen again?" Catra snorted.

"Ha ha. I'm guessing all of us are supposed to be a couple years younger by that. Most fairy tales I have read had the main character around sixteen to eighteen, if not younger."

"You have a beautiful voice by the way. Why didn't you tell me?" Catra smirked, cupping Adora's now red face.

"Oh, I.. I wasn't…" she cleared her throat, "I'm not that good."

"You're talented, and modest as ever." Catra smiled, leaning up and kissing her cheek, "I love you."

"I love you too…" Adora wrapped her arms around Catra, holding her close.

The brunette relaxed in the embrace for a few minutes, letting herself be lost in the moment, until a thought occurred to her, "How long have I been here?"

"I'd say at least thirty to forty minutes. Why?"

Sighing, Catra took a step back, "Shadow Weaver sent me out to run some errands for her, and told me to be back in an hour."

Adora raised an eyebrow, "So? Why would you go back at all?"

Letting her hand slide down the blonde's arm, she grasped her hand, intertwining their fingers, "As much as I don't want to, I think for us to be able to escape this stupid place, we have to finish the stories, and I can't do that if I stay here. From what I gathered, this ball is probably where we all were supposed to meet, so let's agree to meet there tonight. We can find Sparkles and Arrow Boy, and hopefully find a way home."

Frowning, Adora nodded, "Alright. I'll stay here for a while to make sure Light Hope doesn't come back, then I'll leave to find the castle and have a look around. Maybe I can find Bow or Glimmer before then and tell them what we know."

"Okay, princess. I'll.. see you tonight?"

"I'll see you then."

The two smiled, sharing a tender embrace, a kiss they were both hesitant to break. Once they did, however, Adora used her hair to gently lower Catra back to the ground. They each waved, and the blonde watched her lover walk away and disappear before making any move to depart from the window sill.

A Glimmering Rose

Chapter Summary

> Glimmer wakes up, far more confident as she knew what was happening. She does her best to adjust and hopes to find her friends.

Chapter Notes

> A little bit of a shorter chapter, but it's about to get wild!

Glimmer knew what had happened the second she'd opened her eyes dressed in a simple lavender dress in a cottage hidden in the Whispering Woods.

"Of all stories, I'm given a princess who barely speaks? That's gonna be the first change." She mumbled, making her way out of the small bedroom and to the main room of the cottage, where she was greeted by familiar faces, "Aunt Casta? Spinnerella? Netossa?"

"Good morning, sweetheart. Happy birthday!" Spinnerella smiled, pulling her into a hug.

"Thank you.." Glimmer hummed, trying to get into her head she was no longer a twenty two year old queen, but a sixteen year old princess that had no idea of her real family heritage.

"We know it's your special day, but were hoping you could go pick some berries for us!" Castaspella asked, "We need them for your

birthday dinner!"

"Oh! Uh, yeah- sure!" Glimmer squeaked as a cape was draped around her shoulders, looking up as Netossa adjusted the hood on her head before giving her a basket.

"Great! Be back in an hour or two, and don't talk to strangers!"

"Yes, uh- aunt Netossa." Glimmer snorted, smiling as she was pushed out of the cottage, the door shutting behind her, "That totally didn't scream birthday surprise." Glimmer muttered, rolling her eyes fondly as she made her way down the dirt path, hoping to find berries- and her friends.

⚔

Bow groaned as he trudged through the forest, wishing he had brought literally anything to rest on. He'd been walking for a few hours, just mindlessly wandering the woods in hopes of finding someone.

He was starting to think he had gone in the complete wrong direction when the sudden sound of bushes rustling and groans of frustration caught his attention. Furrowing his eyebrows, he slowly approached some brush, pushing aside a branch to reveal Adora struggling with her hair and the surrounding forest. Bow couldn't help but crack an amused smile as he started to approach, "Need some help?"

Adora turned, sighing in relief, "Yes! I don't know what cursed story I'm in but I hate it!"

With a chuckle, Bow guided Adora to sit on a nearby log before taking a seat next to her, "You're Rapunzel. Unfortunately she comes with a lot of hair. Fortunately, I can help make the load easier."

"You have scissors?" Adora's eyes lit up.

"... Nnno. But! I do have mad braiding skills!"

Though she was slightly disappointed, Adora nodded, and turned, allowing her friend to begin the grueling process of braiding her hair and keeping her somewhat still, "Have you found Glimmer?"

"Not yet," Bow frowned, "You find Catra?"

"I did, but she had to continue her..story? She said she's in a house where Perfuma and Mermista are her sisters but they're like- really mean, and Shadow Weaver is her step mother..?"

Sucking in a sharp breath, Bow bit his lip, before exhaling slowly, "She's Cinderella then. That was definitely not the best way to introduce her to Rebellion stories."

"Nope.. Who are you?"

"Snow White. Basically she lives with her step mother who hates her and tries to poison her but she's saved by true love's kiss."

"Sounds familiar." Adora giggled, "So- who is your-?"

"Entrapta. Funny enough, I already finished my story technically because she figured out the whole dimension spell thing. She's actually looking for the others for me as we speak. She actually knows this universe's version of you and Glimmer- kinda."

"How?"

"She told me that you two were princesses that were related, and that you were missing, and that tonight was the first time Glimmer would be seen because of a royal ball- wait! That's it!" Eyes lighting up, Bow smiled as something dawned on him.

"What? What is it?" Adora turned to him.

"The ball! Catra is Cinderella, and the whole point of her story is to go to the ball, and Glimmer is Aurora, who had a ball in honor of her sixteenth birthday. Details are a bit different because the

stories have been intertwined, but I think this whole "mission" if you will, is for us to all meet and finish our stories at that party!"

"That makes sense!" The blonde smiled, "So we just need to find the castle because Glimmer is gonna be there anyway, and Catra should find her way there as well?"

"Basically. I think it would still help to find Glimmer beforehand to make sure she's in the loop, but if we can't it hopefully won't be too big of a deal."

"Great! First we just have to fix this mess of hair I-"

"-I'm already done."

"What-?" Adora stood and looked, seeing her hair was now just off the ground, braided and styled into a comfortable and much lighter load, "Oh wow! Thank you!" She hugged the archer as he got to his feet, "That feels so much better. I still wish we could just cut it though."

For a moment, Bow considered telling Adora what would happen if she did, but decided against it. She could have some fun figuring things out on her own as the story played out, "Sorry, but I'm glad this helps you somewhat."

Nodding, Adora finally got a look at her friend's outfit, "Wow, you look adorable in that. Glimmer's gonna love it."

Blushing, Bow cleared his throat, "Yeah well- just wait until you see Catra tonight. I have a feeling her dress is gonna be a lot more beautiful than whatever you saw her in earlier."

"Hmm, well I can't wait." Adora smiled at the thought, "By the way, do we know when this ball is supposed to start?" She asked as they finally started walking again.

"My guess is this evening, so if we don't find Glimmer by sunset, we just need to head to the castle."

"Alright!"

The duo walked for about ten minutes before Adora spoke again, "Do you know where we can find shoes? My feet are killing me…"

"... Right- uhmm. Maybe we'll head to town a little sooner for that."

⚔

Glimmer had been picking berries for nearly an hour and a half before she heard voices.

"... Just next time we need to be prepared before we jump into a random book."

"Hey, I agree. I still think this is kinda fun though!"

"Bow? Adora?" Glimmer gasped, turning as her friends approached on the nearby pathway.

"Glimmer!" The two exclaimed upon seeing her, laughing as she rushed over and the three fell into a group hug.

"Ooh I missed you two I'm sorry about the spell and- wow. You two look nice!"

"And in pain! My feet. My feet are in pain." Adora huffed, crossing her arms.

"Righhhht, you're Rapunzel, clearly. And Bow-" Glimmer blushed, "Snow White. Cute!"

Blushing, Bow pressed a kiss to Glimmer's forehead, "I could say the same to you, Briar Rose."

"I thought she was Aurora?" Adora raised an eyebrow.

"I am, but when Aurora was in hiding her aunts gave her the name Briar Rose as a disguise." Glimmer explained, "But how did you already-?"

"It's a long story, but basically you and Adora are sisters in this universe. You went into hiding after Adora was kidnapped as an infant, and tonight there's a huge ball in honor of your return. Speaking of, Catra is Cinderella."

"With Shadow Weaver as her step mother." Adora added.

Gasping, Glimmer bit her lip, "Oooh, jeez- that's not good.. Where is she now?"

"She had to go. She figured out the way to escape the book is to play the story. We'll see her at the ball tonight." Adora smiled.

Bow and Glimmer both shared a knowing look of how exactly Catra would manage that, but didn't voice it. They didn't need Adora murdering anyone, especially when they were just playing a part.

"Right. Well, in that case, I need to get back to my cottage. My aunt Casta, Spinnerella, and Netossa are waiting, totally not with a surprise party or anything." She chuckled, "I'll meet you guys at the castle, and I'll bring you some shoes Adora."

"Thank you!" The blonde smiled wider, hugging her friend again.

"I guess we'll head into town then," Bow mused, "See you there?"

"Mhm!"

Glimmer and Bow shared a brief kiss before the trio separated, Adora and Bow making their way to Brightmoon.

All that Glitters

Chapter Summary

> The ball to bring the squad together is here! Will Catra make it? Will Glimmer get past the curse? How will they react to seeing someone they long thought lost?
>
> Will they get home?

Chapter Notes

> Ahhhh strap in! This is the big chapter I think everyone has been waiting for! Please let me know what you think, I poured my heart and soul into this au for this one chapter. XD

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra sighed as she scrubbed the floors of the manor, her ears still pinned back as she wiped the soapy rag across the floor. She missed Adora, Melog, hell, even Sparkles and Bow. She missed Brightmoon, and she absolutely despised the way she was being treated. The whole experience of being in a Rebellion fairytale might've been better if she had been expecting it and was prepared, but right now, she just wanted to find her friends and her girlfriend and go home.

"Catra!"

Flinching, Catra slowly looked up. She also wanted to be back where this demon was dead, "..yes, step mother?" She had to fight the bile in her throat every time she was forced to utter those words.

"Are you almost finished here? The girls need your help getting ready!"

"Yes… just, give me a few more minutes," she requested softly. She needed to stay on Shadow Weaver's good side, she needed to get to that ball, "Uhm, speaking of… is there any chance I could..you know, go too..?"

"Hm. With how you acted this morning I shouldn't allow it. But, if you can finish your chores and find something suitable to wear, sure."

Smiling for the first time since she saw Adora, Catra nodded, "Thank you, step mother."

"Now, hurry along. You still have much to do!" Shadow Weaver said before turning on her heel and going upstairs.

With newfound confidence, Catra hurried to finish the floor. Sure, she knew this was a longshot, but just maybe, Shadow Weaver would be nice to her in more than just her dying moments.

⚔

It had taken all of her willpower and perseverance, but Catra had been able to get all of the chores done and helped the girls get

ready. Now she just needed a dress.

She was currently rummaging through her wardrobe, trying to find something not torn or patched together. Finally, she found a simple red dress that seemed to be suitable. It had short, lacy sleeves, a puffed out flowing skirt, and a gold belt with a black lace sheer over the skirt.

Changing quickly, she let her hair down and brushed it out before doing a small twirl in front of her mirror. It wasn't the best, but surely this would do! Smiling to herself, she made her way back downstairs, just as Perfuma, Mermista, and Shadow Weaver were approaching the door, "Wait, please! I finished my chores and I- I think this is nice enough to wear!" She offered a crooked smile as she approached them.

"What?!"

"How?"

"Mother, you can't let her go! Look at her, she-"

"Girls! Girls.." Shadow Weaver held up a hand to stop the two from yelling at her anymore, "I believe Catra and I made a bargain. She finished her work, and seems to have found something nice to wear."

Catra gave a tiny nod and smile.

"And I would never go back on my word…"

The shift in tone made Catra frown. She didn't like how uneasy it made her feel.

"Nice huh? I don't know, I think it's a little torn." Mermista smirked, waving her hand and sending a quick slice of water through one of her sleeves.

"Hey!" Catra's eyes widened, trying to take a step back, only for vines to wrap around her ankles and keep her there. She gasped when Perfuma approached.

"Yeah, I don't know Catra. It kinda looks like you've been gardening all day!" More vines grew, cutting through the lace and skirt of the dress, sending fabric to the floor.

"W-wait! Stop-!" Catra squeaked when Mermista also stepped up to her and grabbed her shoulder, tearing one of the sleeves clean off.

"Honestly I don't think you should be wearing something that tears apart so easily!"

"P-please stop!" Catra cried, the vines restraining her and the oncoming assault sending her into an impending panic attack.

"Aw don't worry, Catra. We're only trying to help! We wouldn't want you going out dressed like that!" Another vine tore through the gown, tearing the belt and sending it to the floor.

"Girls!" Shadow Weaver finally interfered before there was nothing to hold the torn gown up at all, "That's quite enough. Come along."

Snickering, Perfuma and Mermista turned and walked out to the carriage, the vines finally receding.

"Good night." Shadow Weaver offered a smile as she closed the door behind her, leaving the magicat alone, still frozen in place.

Catra stared ahead at the door for a few moments before tears began rolling down her face. She didn't know what else to do. Overwhelmed with emotion, she turned on her feet and ran, running until she reached the garden in the backyard, collapsing under a large willow tree.

She pulled her legs to her chest, her tail wrapping around them as she broke down crying. She gasped for breath as she sobbed, fighting not to actually start hyperventilating as she pressed her head to her knees. Why? Why was the universe so cruel to her? What did she do to deserve this? Why-

"Wildcat?"

Breath hitching, Catra looked up, "S-Scorpia?"

Sure enough, in front of her was Scorpia. The woman was dressed in her outfit from princess prom, and unlike everyone else, offered her a kind smile, "Hey. What's the matter..?"

"N-nothing…" she sniffed, wiping her eyes as she slowly got to her feet, "What are you doing here..?"

"Oh! Right, duh. I'm here to help you get to the ball!"

"That's really nice, but I don't think I'm in any shape for that.."

"Well, not yet, maybe. But you will be! We just need to fix you up a little and get you a carriage!"

"Do I even want to know how you're supposed to manage that?"

"Well, a little magic, and help from a friend of mine, but we'll worry about that in a moment. We need to get you dressed."

"But- but how-" her eyes widened when she saw Scorpia's pincers glow, "Wait! I don't-!" She gasped, closing her eyes and waiting for the electric shock to follow.

But it didn't.

Instead, she opened her eyes to see herself surrounded in glitter and magic that morphed itself into a new ball gown, one that was absolutely beautiful.

She sneezed as the magic particles settled, before admiring the new dress. Now a bluish silver with off-shoulder sleeves and a snug corset around her torso. At her waist was a golden wing pin that brought a blush to her cheeks, and a long flowing skirt. To top off the look was a black choker with a golden pendant of her mask, and her actual headpiece on her head, but now made of-

"Glass?" She raised an eyebrow at Scorpia.

"Huh, yeah I guess that is a little different. But it looks wonderful! You look beautiful!"

Blushing again, Catra approached, wrapping her arms around her in a hug, "Thank you, Scorps… this means so much to me…" she whispered.

"Aw, of course Wildcat! You deserve to be happy."

"I don't know about that-"

"Nonsense! You do. Oh! Right, it's late and you need a ride. Come on!" Taking her hand, Scorpia quickly led her around to the front of the manor, where a carriage was waiting.

"How did you-"

"Catra!" Entrapta exclaimed as she hopped out of the carriage, approaching the two, "Wow! You look spectacular!"

"Uh- than- thank you. Where did you?"

"Scorpia and I are friends. After Bow left to find you all, I did research of my own and after consulting with Scorpia here I offered my carriage to get you to the ball! It's vital you be there to get back to your dimension!"

"I-" Catra blinked a few times before deciding not to question it.

"Oh! One more thing, Wildcat. My magic will only last until midnight. After that, your dress will be back as it was before."

"That should be plenty of time. Thank you, both of you." The magicat pulled her friends into a hug, smiling at them before getting into the carriage, the driver cracking the whip, and before she knew it, she was off to the palace.

⚔

Adora's eyes sparkled as she approached Brightmoon palace. It was alive with activity, guests arriving from everywhere for the ball, "It's been a while since I've seen this place so lively."

"Me too, but I guess that's the point for the story."

"Do you think Glimmer is here?"

"I'm sure she is, we just have to find her, and Catra."

Nodding, Adora and Bow ascended the stairs, the blonde now adorning a pair of black flats Glimmer had given her.

The two climbed the staircase together, making their way inside to the ballroom, "Whoa… it's packed in here…"

Bow placed a hand on the small of Adora's back, "It's alright. I'm sure we'll find the others soon. You'll be alright."

Nodding, Adora took a deep breath, looking around. Her eyes widened when they landed on Shadow Weaver. She immediately ducked behind the archer.

"Adora what-" his eyes widened when he too spotted her, "Oh- well, don't worry, she won't recognize you, and she won't bother you."

"Okay…okay.. yeah…" the blonde sighed, standing up straight to look around. Adora gasped again, "Bow…"

Bow followed her gaze, his own eyes widening when Angella and Micah entered the room, "Angella…"

"Come on, we should say hi. I'm supposed to be her lost daughter right?"

"Wouldn't hurt," Bow approved, smiling. They made their way across the ballroom to the king and queen, giving a small curtsey upon approaching.

"Prince Bow! Lovely to see you again." Micah smiled, bowing respectfully.

"Who is this beautiful young.." Angella trailed off as she got a good look at the blonde in front of her, "... Adora?"

Tearing up, Adora nodded, breath hitching as she was pulled into a warm embrace.

When Micah turned to Bow for an explanation, he could only laugh before giving a simple, "Surprise..!"

Glimmer entered the room moments later, tearing up as soon as her eyes landed on her mother. She hurried over and threw her arms around Angella and Adora, "Mom!"

Micah, with tears of his own running down his face, turned to face the crowd, "Ladies, Gentlemen, and Attendants! It is my great honor to announce that this ball is no longer just for the return of Princess Glimmer, but also the return of Princess Adora!"

The crowd cheered, the royal sisters smiling and giving a wave, though neither detached from Angella.

"I take it your hair still has the.. special abilities, Adora?" The queen asked.

Blushing, Adora nodded, playing with a loose strand in front of her ear.

"Well, you look beautiful. You both do. I love you both," She finished, kissing them both on their cheeks, "We'll be sure to have a special breakfast for tomorrow, but for now, why don't you enjoy your party?"

"We will mom…" Glimmer smiled, wiping her eyes. She took Bow's arm when she realized he was offering, the three stepping aside together, "I can't believe… I…"

"I guess we should have assumed because Shadow Weaver but… I almost don't wanna leave now." Adora hummed, "I never thought we'd see her again."

"This gives me an idea though," Bow said, "Entrapta said whoever removed the sword would be trapped between dimensions, not die. And this.. this is all technically a different dimension, and portals are possible now, I think this is the confirmation we needed to start trying to save her."

Both women nodded, before something caught Adora's attention.

Time seemed to slow for her as her eyes landed on Catra as she slowly entered the ballroom, looking around nervously.

"Wow… !" She breathed, her cheeks burning red.

"Go on~"

Adora turned at Glimmer's teasing tone, "H-Huh?"

"Come on, Adora. She's your girlfriend. Go ask her for a dance. You two deserve it."

Nodding, the blonde took a deep breath, before moving to meet Catra.

Bow felt his face heat up as he turned to look at Glimmer, finally taking in the beautiful attire she adorned. She was now wearing her crown, and a lavender ball gown with a sweetheart neckline, a sequin sash over the skirt, and short sleeves just barely off the shoulder. She had a sky blue glove on one arm, and a choker with a half moon pendant, and a matching pendant on her waist.

"You look so beautiful, Glimmer…" he hummed, gently taking her hand.

"Thank you. You don't look too bad yourself." She snorted, "I can't believe you never told me how amazing you look in a skirt."

"I didn't know either until now." He chuckled, "Hey uhm, did you maybe wanna dance too before..?"

"I'd love to. Lead?"

"Of course."

⚔

Adora slowly crossed the ballroom, approaching the magicat, "Catra… you look so beautiful…"

Blushing, Catra bit her lip, "Thank you… you look beautiful too… I love the braid."

"Thanks, Bow did it for me. Hey uhm, I know we have a whole escape thing to do, but… Would you like to dance?"

Giggling, Catra nodded, taking the blonde's offered hand, "I would love to…"

⚔

Adora giggled as she twirled Catra before pulling her in close, "No wonder you led at prom, this is fun!"

"Hey, you're the one in more flexible attire. It's only fair." Catra hummed, smiling up at the blonde as they continued to waltz around the room.

"This whole fairytale experience isn't so bad, huh?"

".. This part isn't." Catra muttered, causing Adora to frown.

"What do you mean?"

"Well… uhm-"

They twirled again, falling into the curse of Etheria's multi partner dance tradition. Adora was now in Bow's arms and Catra in Glimmer's.

"Long time no see, Sparkles."

"Ha ha. Hey, listen, I heard what story you're in, I'm so sorry. I had no clue this would happen." Glimmer apologized as she lifted Catra and spun her halfway before setting her down.

"It's alright, Glim, really. The more I think about it, it has actually been kinda fun. It's not too often our missions involve parties and not fighting clones."

Glimmer snorted, "Fair enough. You look amazing, by the way."

"You don't look so bad yourself, Sparkles."

They were soon swapped out again, but with random people at the party, only catching glances of each other for a few minutes as the dance continued.

While the others wound up with partners they didn't even know, Glimmer found herself in Double Trouble's arms.

"Double Trouble?" Glimmer was surprised, staring up at the former Horde fugitive.

"Nice to see you again, darling."

"Uhm- again?" She smiled nervously, not considering the fact they could be a part of her story somehow.

"Don't flatter yourself, princess. It hasn't been that long. Though I suppose it would be nice to.. catch up?"

Glimmer finally realized she had been led off the dance floor, "Catch up- what do you..?" She gasped when she made eye contact with Double Trouble, only to see glowing, almost hypnotic eyes staring back. She tried to look away, but couldn't. Her feet moved on their own, forcing her to reclimb the stairs, and away from the others.

⚔

Catra laughed as she was twirled back into Adora's arms before the blonde dipped her, the dance coming to a close.

"This feels familiar," Adora teased, pulling the brunette up and kissing her nose.

"Adoraaa.." Catra blushed, burying her face in her shoulder.

"Hey guys?" Bow approached, causing the women to look at him, "Have you seen Glimmer?"

"The ballroom is packed, Bow. She could be anywhere." Adora shrugged.

"Yeah but.. I don't know. Something feels off."

"Well, you never told us the full story she's in. Does she have a villain?"

The archer's eyes widened when a thought dawned on him.

"Uh-oh. That's not a good look." Catra frowned.

"In Sleeping Beauty, Aurora has a villain named Maleficent, who tricks her into pricking her finger on a spinning wheel that curses her to sleep forever until she receives true love's kiss."

"Eww." Catra laughed, "That's the cringiest shit I've ever heard."

"Cringe or not, she's not in the room, and she could be under a spell right now."

"Calm down, Arrow Boy. You're her 'true love' aren't ya? Go save her then! We'll wait here."

Though he was now blushing furiously, Bow nodded and turned on his heel, and raced to the stairs, determined to find his girlfriend.

⚔

Glimmer was internally screaming, fighting the spell that forced her closer and closer to the glowing spinning wheel ahead of her.

"Nothing personal, darling; mostly." She heard Double Trouble call behind her, just as her finger touched the spindle, and her world went black.

Bow arrived moments later, glad Glimmer was at least alone now. One less villain battle. He collapsed at her side, cradling her in his arms, "I'm sorry I wasn't paying attention.." He muttered, brushing a strand of hair out of her face. Despite knowing it would be okay, he felt guilt pulling at his chest.

Carefully, he leaned down and pressed his lips to Glimmer's in a gentle kiss, his nerves fading as he felt her return the embrace a few moments later.

"Mm.. Bow?" She whispered once they pulled apart.

"Hey, Glimmer. Are you okay?"

"I'm fine, thanks to you…" After sitting up, a thought occurred, "Is.. Is that it? We're all together, and defeated our villains?"

"I… don't know. I have and, I guess you have too by getting past the curse, and Catra technically has too by being here. But what about Adora?"

"I'm not sure, let's go ask her I guess."

Getting to their feet, they made their way back to the ballroom.

⚔

"Oh, you found her, thank goodness." Adora smiled, approached with Catra when Glimmer and Bow returned.

"Yeah, I'm okay. But, Adora. Who was keeping you in the tower?"

Tensing, the blonde bit her lip, "Light Hope. Why?"

"Have you even seen her since you left?"

Adora shook her head, "No, I got her to leave on a three day trip to get me paint or something."

Bow and Glimmer shared looks, "Does that count?"

Glimmer shrugged, "We're still here so- something has to be left."

The squad gasped when the clock suddenly rang throughout the room.

Midnight.

Catra's eyes widened, "A-Adora? Can we go outside? Like now- please?"

"What? Why?"

"Well uh, it's hard to explain!" She looked to the others for help, who both seemed to realize at the same time.

"Right! I completely forgot, come on!" Bow gasped, and they all quickly made their way to the palace gardens, despite Adora being utterly confused.

"Can someone tell me what's going on?" Adora asked, flinching at another stroke of the clock.

"It's part of Catra's story that would be easier to explain not in front of a crowd of-" Glimmer was cut off by the clock ringing through the courtyard again.

Catra gasped at the final stroke of midnight that caused a glow of magic to surround her, before fading away to reveal her back in her torn red gown from before. All that was left of her previous dress was her glass headpiece.

"Oh, Catra- what happened?" Adora immediately took her hand.

"It's a long story, Adora. I really don't wanna-"

"Adora?!"

"Catra?!"

The couple flinched, looking back to see Shadow Weaver and Light Hope standing there, glaring at them.

"How dare you blatantly disobey me!" Shadow Weaver yelled, taking a few steps closer to the two.

"Me? I didn't disobey you!" Catra finally snapping, "You said if I finished my work and found something nice to wear I could come,

and guess what? I did!"

"You ungrateful little-"

"I'd take a step away from her if I were you." Glimmer sneered, glaring at the woman, who took a step back.

"P-princess? This should not concern you, she is my daughter-"

"I am NOT your daughter! You've done nothing but hurt and abuse me all day, and I will not be following you!"

"And as the princess, I demand you leave. So, bye bye!" Glimmer smirked.

"Yeah! Same thing Glimmer said!" Adora added, both of them reveling in the way Shadow Weaver could only glare before turning and storming off.

"Adora, what are you even doing here?" Light Hope said, pushing past the others and grabbing her arm.

"I think it should be obvious. I learned you kidnapped me as a baby, that I'm the missing princess, and returned home."

Hope stared momentarily before laughing, "Oh, sweetheart you're too naive if you're really falling for-"

"Can we skip the gaslighting bit please?" Adora glared, "I'm not stupid! I'm not following you! You can't make me!"

Eyes darkening, Hope opened her mouth to speak, before she was abruptly cut off by Catra.

"Nope! Fuck this, not doing anymore fake mom bullshit!" She ranted as she grabbed her headpiece and smashed it on the ground, using the biggest piece to slice through Adora's hair, sending all but just a little past her shoulder to the floor, "There! Leave her alone, no more magic hair!"

"No! What have you done!?" Light Hope gasped, feeling the aging process immediately beginning to catch up with her, "You will regret this! You-" she cried out in anger and frustration, before rushing out of sight, not wanting to be seen for who she really was.

"Is.. Is that it?" Adora asked, smiling at how light her hair was now, realizing it was no longer She-Ra's platinum blonde, but her own blonde hair color, "Can we go home now?"

The aura of magic beginning to surround them was their answer. Smiling, they all hugged each other as they returned back to where they belonged.

Chapter End Notes

I'll post a short epilogue soon!

Home

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

When Catra opened her eyes, she looked around, running her fingers through her pixie cut and inspecting Adora's attire before sighing in relief, "Thank god we're finally home!"

"That…That was something." Bow chuckled.

"It was fun, just- wish we had had some warning. And you know, that it hadn't happened this late." Adora yawned, wrapping her arms around Catra, who happily snuggled up to her.

"Well, maybe when we're more prepared, and have the time, we could do that again?" Glimmer asked, hopefully.

"Maybe, Sparkles." Catra yawned herself, closing her eyes, "Just give me time to recover from being assaulted by Mermista and Perfuma."

"I'm sorry- what?" Adora glared, looking down at her lover.

"Long story, Adora.. I'll tell you in the morning…"

"Depending on how things go." Bow agreed, curling up in a beanbag on the floor, "I'd like to do that again one day too."

"Fair enough." The queen smiled fondly at her friends and boyfriend as they all fell asleep, her friends on the loveseat. She carefully picked up the book and returned it to the shelf, before joining Bow on the beanbag and closing her eyes. They could talk about everything tomorrow. She hoped in the future they would be able to save her mom, rebuild Etheria, do everything they had to, but also have time to return to these fairytale adventures; it was a calming thing for Glimmer, and she hoped it could be for the others too.

For now though, it was time to rest

Chapter End Notes

I really hope you all loved this AU as much as I did making it! I left it open to make a sequel if I get the inspiration for it in the future. Currently, I have a Rebellion Catra AU in the works 👀

Future posts will probably be a few one shots until I get ready to start posting the new AU. I'm currently in lots of tooth pain and prepping to have a molar/wisdom tooth removed in a couple weeks, so I'm sleeping more than I would like to at the moment. So please be patient with me! 🥰

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